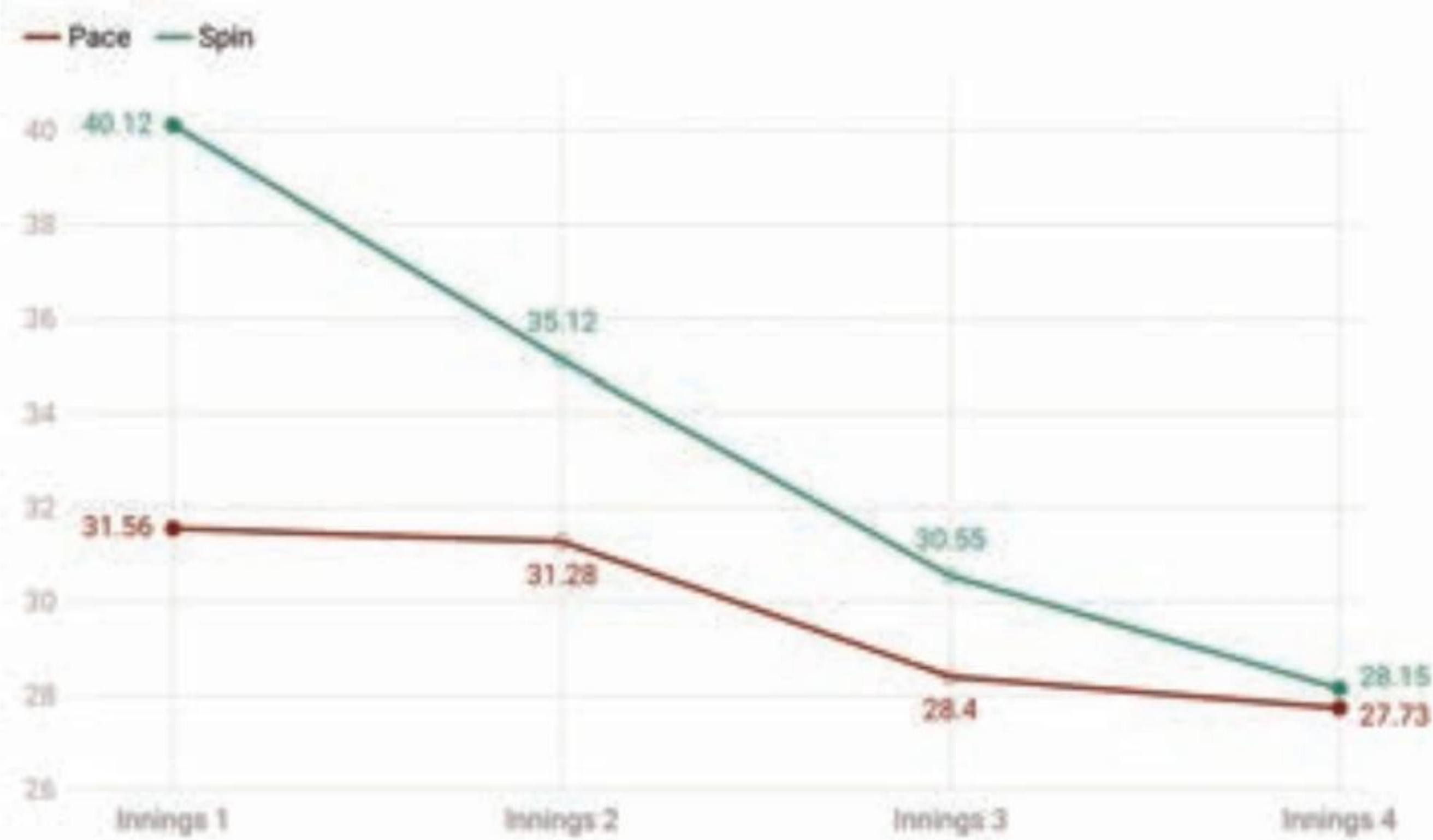


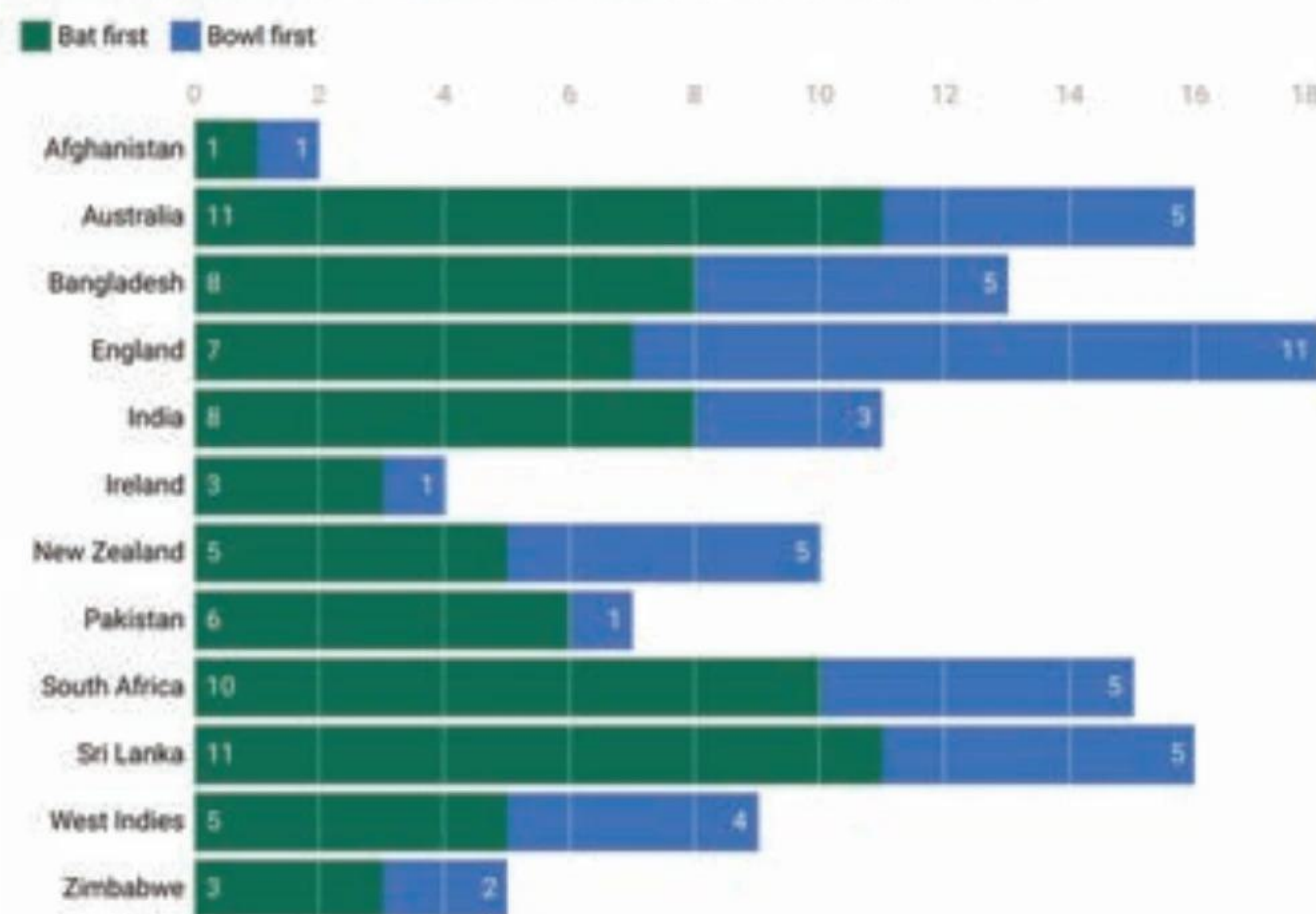
England's 200+ chases in Test cricket in Bazball Era

Opposition	Target	Venue	Date
New Zealand	277	Lord's	2 June 2022
New Zealand	299	Nottingham	10 June 2022
New Zealand	296	Leeds	23 June 2022
India	378	Birmingham	1 July 2022
Australia	251	Leeds	6 July 2023
Sri Lanka	205	Manchester	21 August 2024
India	371	Leeds	20 June 2025

Difference in spin and pace bowling average in Tests across innings



Toss decisions in Test cricket since June 2022



traditional English Test strategy.

Until their leadership began, England chose to bowl first in home Tests only once every five matches. In the 539 Tests hosted in England up to that point, teams opted to field first on just 114 occasions.

Since June 2022, when McCullum took over as Test coach, no team has inserted the opposition more often — both in absolute numbers and proportionally.

The only side that comes close is New Zealand, which has split its toss decisions evenly.

The first toss won by England under the Kiwi coach came in the second Test against New Zealand at Nottingham in 2022. Stokes chose to field, laying the groundwork for a successful chase — a method soon to be replicated with style.

Over the past four years, England has won more Tests (15) batting second than any other side, registering a staggering win-loss ratio of 3.00 in such matches.

In this period, England has twice entered the top 10 highest successful chases in Test history — both against India, first in Birmingham in 2022 and again in Leeds in 2025.

Only once in eight home Tests has England failed to chase down a target above 200 — at Lord's during the 2023 Ashes. Despite Stokes' valiant 155, the side fell 43 runs short of a 371-run target.

It's worth noting that all of England's 200-plus chases in the past four years have come at home. Its highest successful fourth-innings chase overseas under Stokes and McCullum remains 167, against Pakistan in Karachi.

All its attempts to chase a higher total away from home have ended in defeat — including a narrow one-run loss to New Zealand in 2023.

Dulling spin threat

A key element of England's successful chases at home has been how it has subtly tweaked its conditions to reduce the impact of spin in the fourth innings, offering its batters a more familiar, less volatile surface.